

Sales open, and the east shuts

● NETWORK: AMBER

It's the week leading up to Dussehra in India: Amazon's sale opens tonight¹, and tomorrow, Flipkart starts their early access². Most of India looks pretty much like it does around Dussehra - slightly stretched, but fine³, except the east. Odisha shuts for a bandh tomorrow⁴. Kolkata keeps goods vehicles out on Saturday and curbs them all the way to 27th October (Tuesday)⁵. And the sea routes out of India into the Gulf are still shut. On Monday, 11 Indian sailors were reported hurt⁶.



HOW'S EACH REGION HOLDING UP?

North ● GREEN

Delhi's roads ran 17 points above usual yesterday⁷, likely due to the INDIA bloc's march through central Delhi⁸. Too early to call it more than the season, so it stays Green.

West ● GREEN

Apart from seasonal effects, things look steady. JNPA's trucks were in and out in about an hour and a half on Tuesday⁹.

South ● GREEN

The usual sale-week strain in Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Chennai. IMD sees a low over the Andaman Sea around 13th October¹⁰.

East ● RED

Tomorrow's Odisha bandh comes with blockades in the mining belts⁴, then Saturday's truck ban in Kolkata. Congress has promised a seven-day mining blockade after Dussehra, dates not confirmed¹¹.

Northeast ● AMBER

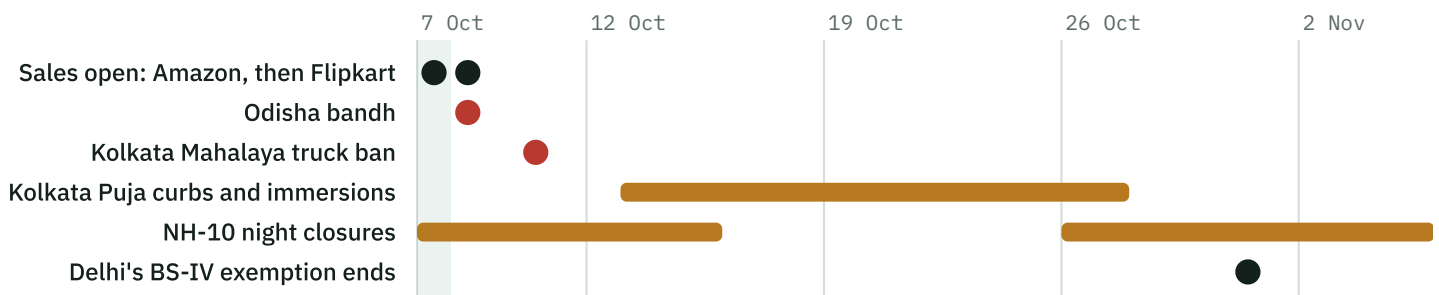
NH-10 into Sikkim is shut at night from tonight. The Silchar road is expected to have heavy rain today.

Central ● GREEN

Nothing beyond the usual seasonal strain. Pretty boring, but in a good way.

● GREEN the season as usual, which in sale weeks can still be busy • ● AMBER something beyond the season is slowing freight • ● RED something is stopping freight across a state or a major route

DATES TO WATCH



DECISIONS TO MAKE

- 1 Sale volume lands on every metro hub at once, starting tonight^{1,2}. Whatever backlog you carry into tomorrow stays for the whole peak, and there is no respite after it to clear the hubs. **How much extra sort and linehaul do you run this week?**
- 2 The east stops twice in the first three days of the sale - Odisha's bandh, then Kolkata's Mahalaya truck ban - and from 13th October, trucks serving Kolkata port get four hours a day⁵. With curbs that long, going early is the least risky bet here. **Which eastern loads move before the bandh on 8th October (Thursday), and which Diwali-critical imports clear Kolkata port before 13th October (Tuesday)?**
- 3 The Gulf route is shut, and westbound air and ocean space is tight going into peak¹². Waiting for prices to drop sounds nice. May be they will, but I wouldn't bet the Diwali orders on it. **How much Europe and US space do exporters commit for peak-season orders while some is still available?**

NETWORK INSIGHTS

Cost of a delay is my call: High where a delay holds up export orders or warehouse inputs; Medium for stock replenishment.

1 The first 72 hours

HIGH CONFIDENCE

Helpline searches in sale weeks, times a normal week

	2022	2023	2024	2025
Kolkata	2.2x	2.5x	3.8x	6x
Chennai	1.5x	1.4x	1.6x	2.2x
Delhi	1.7x	1.2x	1.4x	1.9x
Bengaluru	1.4x	1.8x	1.5x	1.8x
Hyderabad	1.4x	1.8x	2.8x	1.4x
Mumbai	1.4x	1.4x	1.4x	1.4x

Helpline searches rise in every sale week, and in West Bengal they have climbed every year³. This year, Flipkart claims more than 900 new festive hubs¹³ and 2.5 lakh seasonal jobs¹⁴. Whether they get filled in time is yet to be seen.

Backlog is like credit-card debt: whatever you carry into Thursday collects interest every day of the peak. Except, nobody gives you a loan in sale week. So outside the east, the first 72 hours decide the sale.

2 The Gulf is shut, so everyone's going west

● RED · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Ships crossing the Strait of Hormuz in a day¹⁵

Before the war  about 85
4th October  about 4

On Monday a projectile hit a tanker in Hormuz and injured 12 of its crew⁶. India–Middle East rates are up 25–40% since late August¹⁶. Westbound, Maersk's US East Coast surcharge is \$7,150 from 2nd October¹⁷, and India–US air tonnage is up 15%, rates 7% in a single week¹⁸.

So the space gets dearer just as the Christmas orders need it. The exposure sits in Gulf contracts priced before late August, and with exporters whose peak orders have nothing booked.

3 Who blinks first on diesel?

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Diesel, ₹ a litre¹⁹

Nayara, from 3rd October		+₹3
State retailers		₹0
State retailers' loss, Sept		about ₹9

Nayara did²⁰. The state retailers, who run over 90% of India's pumps, haven't moved, and with the Centre's diesel excise nil since March, there's no duty left to cut²¹.

Can the state retailers afford not to raise prices in the festive weeks? I don't know, and I won't pretend to. The exposure sits in every contract with automatic diesel pass-through.

4 Rail is the only one adding seats

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

How JNPA's boxes left the port, July²²

Rail 13.5% · Road 86.5%

The Western freight corridor has run from Dadri to JNPA since 8th September²³. Rail loading was up 5.4% in August, domestic containers 9.2%²⁴. Delhi's essential-goods exemption for BS-IV goods vehicles ends this month²⁵.

Freight moved onto the corridor now is capacity booked before late October. After that, Delhi's rules take older trucks out of the pool, just when every shipper wants road space.

MEASURED THIS MORNING

City roads against usual, daily, 30 Sep–6 Oct⁷ **amber = 10+ over**



JNPA truck turnaround, hours⁹



Paradip cargo, thousand tonnes a day²⁶



THE LANES I'M WATCHING

NH-16 Odisha Red tomorrow for the bandh, then Amber while trucks clear.

NH-10 Sikkim Shut 9 pm–6 am on Sevoke–Rangpo, to 15th October and 26th October–5th November²⁷.

NH-6 Shillong, Silchar Heavy rain over Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura today²⁸; Amber till Friday.

NH-44 Jammu–Srinagar Single-lane stretches; tankers only at night²⁹.

Kerala ghats Rain till 11th October, heavy in places on 9th and 10th²⁸.

CALLS I'LL CHECK NEXT WEEK

1. Delhi diesel at the state retailers' pumps is still ₹95.20 on 14th October (Wednesday)³⁰.
2. IMD's Andaman Sea low forms by 14th October, but no Bay depression before 16th.
3. Kolkata's roads run 10+ points above usual on four of the seven curb days, 13th–19th October.

How I rate this, and what I can't see. I rate against the season. A Red road drags down the hubs at both ends, and a hub stays Amber about two days after its cause clears. Sale-week figures count customers chasing parcels, not late parcels. Built from public sources only. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery, not measured service levels. Every number links to its source; all 30 are at thefavrito.github.io/editions/2026-10-07/. Map boundaries: [DataMeet](#), CC BY 4.0.